PD: LEADERSHIP COMPETENCIES (ENGR 4010)- Fall 2026- Tuesday
Archer Center for Student Leadership Development (ACSLD)

Section	Day and Time	Instructor/Email
4 **CRN# 77745**	**Tuesdays 12-1:50pm**	**Amy Youmans corroa@rpi.edu** **Academy Hall 2232**
5 **CRN# 77746**	**Wednesdays 12-1:50pm**	**Dr. Trisha Teig teigt@rpi.edu** **Academy Hall 2232**
7 **CRN# 77747**	**Tuesdays 2-3:50pm**	**Dr. Trisha Teig teigt@rpi.edu** **Academy Hall 2232**
8 **CRN#** 77748	**Tuesdays 2-3:50pm**	**Amy Youmans corroa@rpi.edu** **Academy Hall 2232**

Office Hours: By appointment. Available both in-person and via Webex. Please email or contact instructors via Webex for office hour appointments.

PDLC Mission Statement & Course Description:
The Professional Development: Leadership Competencies course complements Professional Development 1 / Introduction to Engineering Design by further developing leadership competencies which students will apply in their work as new engineering professionals. Through experiential learning, students will develop the foundations of/= effective communication skills, emotional intelligence, cultural competency, ethical decision-making, and critical thinking.

The experiential learning in this course will be facilitated by creating and participating in an immersive role-playing game (RPG) using the LeadRPG model. The goal of our course's LeadRPG is to use creativity and role-playing to grow our own leadership skills and capacity within the field of Engineering, while we co-create our immersive RPG classroom environment and engage in the game together. We will utilize the main tenants of the LeadRPG model: **Game, Learn, Lead.**

> **Game: Experiencing Together.** Our structured and imaginative play together where story, rules, roles, creativity, and collaboration generate direct experiences.
>
> **Learn: Making Meaning & Growing.** Our reflection on what happened, making meaning, and connecting the game experience to self, group, and wider contexts.
>
> **Lead: Applying & Practicing.** Our insights and action from our gameplay, as well as learning experiences out of game, that we will carry into teamwork and collaborations as future Engineers.

This may be a new type of learning experience for most of you, and role-playing may be outside your comfort zone. We will spend time as a class and in teams developing our roles and creating community norms, so we are able to expand our comfort zones and fully participate in the game. As your instructor, I will work to have the intentional structures in place to guide our gameplay and make space to debrief each gameplay session. I am here to be a resource and answer questions, so you meet your goals for this class. I am excited to be on this learning adventure with you!

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This course addresses the following accreditation requirements from ABET Engineering Criteria:
Engineering programs must demonstrate that their graduates have an ability[…]

- to apply engineering design to produce solutions that meet specified needs with consideration of public health, safety, and welfare, as well as global, cultural, social, environmental, and economic factors.
- to communicate effectively with a range of audiences.
- to recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.
- to function effectively on a team whose members together provide leadership, create a collaborative and inclusive environment, establish goals, plan tasks, and meet objectives.

Learning Objectives:
At the end of PD: Leadership Competencies, students will be able to:

- incorporate philosophical and professional ethical principles within their leadership practices, developing appropriately professional ethical practices.
- utilize critical thinking skills to analyze professional scenarios and determine proper course of action.
- identify their strengths and weaknesses regarding leadership development competencies and articulate a plan for growth.
- recognize the impact of social identities and social inequalities in different professional settings and recommend actions for developing and maintaining inclusive professional environments.

A Potential Typical Class Structure on a Gaming Day:

- 1 hour of Gameplay/Activities
- 30 minutes of Gameplay debrief
- 20 minutes to work on assignments, etc.

Student Game Master Role
As a part of immersive RPG class experience, all students will work with a peer to be Co-Game Masters during an in-class gameplay session. Game Master pairs will be established in Week 2 of class, and partners will have the opportunity to act as Game Masters for Game Days 4 – 7 outlined on the course schedule. Similar to the LeadRPG learning experience, we recognize being a Game Master may be a new and uncomfortable role for some students. We are here to provide guidance and give you the materials and tools you need to be successful. Your main objective as the Game Master is to help guide your team and facilitate the journey of our RPG that week. Instructors will be Game Masters for Game Day 3, so students will be able to observe the Game Master role modeled. All students will receive a maximum of 40 points in the class grading scheme from an average of self and peer evaluations from their Game Master week.

Valuing Diversity & Inclusive Classroom Community:
This course is intended to reach students from diverse backgrounds and perspectives - all are welcome here. The diversity students bring to class, across gender, sexuality, age, disability, socio-economic status, ethnicity, race,

religion, and learning needs is valued as an important asset and strength in the learning process. We will have many opportunities in this class to explore challenging issues and increase our understanding of differing perspectives. Our conversations and structured dialogues may not always be easy, and we will need patience, compassion, and a foundation grounded in trust and respect for others. Therefore, an additional aim of this course is to increase our capacity for these kinds of conversations, as this is a valuable skill in both scholarship and in life. While some of the topics discussed may be controversial, and opinions on all sides are welcome, opinions do need to be supported by reputable sources and facts. We will practice using data to support our claims throughout the semester, with an aim toward increasing competency in this skill.

Student Wellbeing & RPI Campus Resources
All students' holistic wellbeing, including physical, mental, and emotional health, is of paramount importance throughout the duration of the semester. Good health and wellbeing practices contribute to overall academic success. Feel free to communicate with your instructor throughout the semester about your wellbeing, especially if you are ever facing wellbeing or health challenges that may affect your attendance and performance in the course and/or need assistance getting in touch with campus academic support and wellbeing resources.

Below are RPI campus resources and departments that can directly assist students with academic and wellbeing concerns.

- **Student Success Center –** First Floor of Follsom Library (contact info to come)
- **Engineering Academic HUB & Faculty Advisors -** https://eng.rpi.edu/students/advising/first-year-advising-hub
- **Dean of Students Office -** https://doso.rpi.edu/ (518) 276-6266
- **Counseling Center -** https://studenthealth.rpi.edu/list-services/counseling-center (518)-276-6479
- **Mantra Health -** https://studenthealth.rpi.edu/list-services/mental-health-counseling-services/mantra-health https://hub.mantrahealth.com
    - **ConnectNow on-demand support:** (518) 276-8888.
- **Student Health Center -** https://studenthealth.rpi.edu/list-services/student-health-center (518) 276-6287
- **Rec Well at the Mueller Center** https://recwell.rpi.edu/

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Grading Scheme:

This class will utilize a GPA-based grading structure. All assignments will be graded on a 0–40 point scale.

- 40 points= A; 36 points= A-; 33 points= B+; 30 points= B; 26 points= B-; 23 points= C+; 20 points= C; 16 points= C-; 13 points= D+; 10 points= D; <10 point= F

Grading Breakdown:

You must earn at least 60 points from EACH of the three (3) Experience categories, along with a minimum of 200 combined points, to receive a passing grade in the course. See corresponding rubrics in LMS for each assignment's detailed instructions.

- ***Effective Communication Experience- Maximum value 100 points***
  - **Options- worth 40 points a piece**
    - 60 Second Sell write-up/script
    - Completed Leadership Competencies Matrix
    - Peer Feedback forms (at least 3)
    - Lessons Learned reflection (250-500 words)
- ***Cultural Competency Experience- Maximum value 160 points***
  - **Options- worth 40 points a piece**
    - Team Community Agreements
    - Team Organizational Chart
    - Individually completed Social Identity Wheel (with reflection questions answered)
    - Individually completed Emotional Intelligence Matrix
    - Choice of either (includes short paragraph explaining what learned from assessment):
      - APA Race & Ethnicity Reflection
      - Miville-Guzman Universality-Diversity Scale- Short Form
- ***Ethics Experience- Maximum value 160 points***
  - **Options- worth 40 points a piece**
    - Team Decision Tree
    - Team Mission Statement
    - Individually completed Ethics Concept Map- Who/What influences your personal values?
    - Individually completed Reflection- What is the hardest NSPE canon to follow? Why? (250-500 words)
    - Completed list of at least 6 official engineering resources (not including NSPE) that can help you act ethically as an engineer. (Should include links/citations as well as how you believe each resource would help you be a more ethical engineer.)
- ***Game Master Role- Maximum value 40 points***
  - Self-Assessment (avg.) = 20 points
  - Classmates' Assessment (avg.) = 20 points
- ***Final Leadership Challenge- Maximum value 80 points***
  - Team Reflection = 40 points
  - Individual reflection component = 40 points

Total # of possible course points = 540 points

500 points = A;	**460 points= A-;**	**430 points= B+;**	**400 points= B;**
360 points= B-;	**330 points= C+;**	**300 points= C;**	**260 points= C-**
230 points= D+;	**200 points= D;**	**< 200 points =F**	

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EXPECTATIONS AND POLICIES:

Assignment Policy-

All assignments are due via the method and date noted on the syllabus, unless otherwise indicated. Students should be in contact with the instructor as soon as possible (ASAP) if they will need to/ already have missed a class/assignment to verify an absence will be considered excused and a make-up plan can be established.

ALL group members must be present during group presentation days. Failure to be present during these group activities/presentations will result in the loss of the indicated grade percentage for the assignment (s), unless it is due to an excused absence.

Attendance Policy

Classroom attendance is required for this course. Attendance will be taken at the beginning of class. Students are expected to be on time and remain for the full class period. Attendance is critical for success in PDLC. It is the student's responsibility to contact the instructor and to obtain any course materials missed due to excused or unexcused absences. **Beginning the first week of class, students with three (3) or more unexcused absences may fail PDLC. Please note that an unexcused absence on a presentation day will result in an automatic 20-point deduction from your final grade.**

In order for an absence to be considered excused, students must provide appropriate documentation, and obtain permission from the instructor. If the instructor has concerns regarding a student's success; tools may be leveraged to assist in supporting the student. An example may be an EWS submission for concerns relating to but not limited to irregular attendance, missing assignments, below average performance on graded assignments/quizzes. Students are expected to attend the section for which they are registered unless they obtain permission from their instructor.

Academic Integrity

Students are expected to maintain academic integrity. **Participation in academic dishonesty, as defined in the current Rensselaer Student Handbook, may result in failure of the course.** All assignments outside of class must be completed individually unless instructor specifies otherwise. **All assignments must be completed without aid from Artificial Intelligence (AI) software/programs/websites unless prior approval is granted by the instructor.** If it is found that AI was used without instructor permission to complete any assignment, the student will receive a grade of zero (0) for that assignment. All assignments will be submitted via LMS and put through SafeAssign software to check for plagiarism.

Students with Disabilities

We are committed to ensuring full participation of all students in this course. If you have a documented disability (or think you may have a disability) and, as a result, need a reasonable accommodation to participate in this class, complete the course requirements, or benefit from the Institute's programs or services, contact the Office of Disability Services for Students (DSS) as soon as possible. To receive any academic accommodation, you must be appropriately registered with DSS. After registration, contact your instructor as soon as possible to discuss your accommodations so that they may be implemented in a timely fashion. DSS contact information: dss@rpi.edu; 518-276-2231, 4226 Academy Hall.

NOTES:

***Assigned Readings are available via LMS and should be read before prior to attending class.**

**** Students will be assigned to a group during our first class meeting. If you are absent from the first week's class, it is your responsibility to ask as to which group you have been assigned.**

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***NOTE: Unexcused Absences on presentation days will result in a 20-point deduction on your final grade. ***

Class	Dates	Topics	Notes	Assignments
1	Sept. 1st / 2nd	**Introduction/ Course and Game Overview/ Character Development Effective Communication Competency**	• Syllabus Review • Competency-Based Interviewing Strategies • Community Agreements & Character Building	**Upload Community Agreements to General WebEx Chat Space and LMS**
2	Sept. 8th / 9th	**Game Day 1… Who are You? What do You need? Developing Your Character & Worldbuilding Emotional Intelligence Competency**	**Self-Awareness Self- Management** ***READ:** "What Makes a Leader" **Available via LMS**	

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3	Sept. 15th / 16th	**Game Day 2… Character Introduction Effective Communication Competency continued**	**60 Second Sell practice**	
Sept. 22nd / 23rd - NO CLASS- Career Fair				
4	Sept. 29th / 30th	**Game Day 3… Who are We? What are We trying to do? Model Game Play Emotional Intelligence Competency**	**Social Awareness Relationship Management Available via LMS**	**All Effective Communication Competency Experience Assignments due 9AM via LMS**
5	Oct. 6th / 7th	**Game Day 4… Cultural Competency – Self/Identity Student Co-GMs**	***READ:** "Diversity and Human Rights Consortium: What is Cultural Competency?" **Available via LMS**	**Fill out Belonging Survey in class.**
6	Oct. 13th / 14th	**Game Day 5… Cultural Competency – Organizations Student Co-GMs**		**Sign-up in Class for your Leadership Evaluation Day/Pair/Trio** **Pair/Trio must both be members of the same team**
7	Oct. 20th / 21st	**Game Day 6… Critical Incident- What do we do? Critical Thinking/ Problem-Solving & Ethical Practice Student Co-GMs**	***READ:** "Logical Toolkit" **Available via LMS**	
8	Oct. 27th / 28th	**No Class - Prep for Innovation and Final Leadership Challenge Days**		**All Cultural Competency Experience Assignments due 9AM via LMS**
9	Nov. 3rd / 4th	**Game Day 7… Critical Incident Continued- What do we do? Critical Thinking/ Problem-Solving & Ethical Practice Student Co-GMs**	**READ:** "Engineering Codes of Ethics and the Duty to Set a Moral Precedent" **Available via LMS**	**Check-in with instructor for Leadership Evaluation Problem approval**
10	Nov. 10th / 11th	**Gameplay Processing & Debrief Leadership Evaluation Simulation Prep**		**All Ethics Competency Experience Assignments due 9AM via LMS**
11	Nov. 17th / 18th	**Leadership Evaluation Simulations/ Presentations Day 1**	Pairs will have 40 minutes to present and lead teams through their chosen problem. 10 minutes are allotted for the team to provide the Co-leads with feedback.	In-class pair 'problem-solving' presentations
Nov. 25th - NO Class- Thanksgiving break				
12	Dec. 1st / 2nd	**Leadership Evaluation Simulations/ Presentations Day 2**	Pairs will have 40 minutes to present and lead teams through their chosen problem. 10 minutes are allotted for the team to provide the Co-leads with feedback.	In-class pair 'problem-solving' presentations
	Dec 8th / 9th	**Final Class Evaluation, Celebration, and Reflection Day**		**Final Leadership Challenge Reflection Assignment due by 11:59PM on Dec. 8th**